

1 Year Blog-iversary



Doing some side-grinds in the REAL free-to-play (f2p) worlds while writing this

Surprisingly it's been a year since my [first blog](#) and I think now is a good time to not only look back at how my OSRS account has changed but also how my perception of videogames have changed as a result.

Food-stall of Contents:

1. [OSRS Progress](#)
2. [How OSRS differentiates itself](#)
3. [Reflection of blogging as hobby](#)

State of ratratrat33 as of today 🧑

[2025]



[2026]



For those curious, I've been logged in for over 670 hours (nice) and I'd say about 200 of those hours were dedicated to getting 99 Woodcutting and Magic on my second monitor/tablet. In addition I know I started to employ semi-degenerate AFK-ing for the Sailing skill which definitely pumped those numbers up.

I have also ragebaited two bossing parties - responses here with no context:

- I will not raid with someone who has super restore mixes
- this has to be the brokest man ive seen in my life
- a certain zammy brew merchant is buying out the stock anyways

The original goal list I wrote out also had to get checked:

Goal	Why	Importance
99 Magic	Skill Cape (For Spellbook Swaps)	Low
Dragon Slayer II	Vorkath (Boss) is a money printer.	Med
While Guthix Sleeps	Tormented Synapse is BiS against Doom	High
The Path of Glouphrie	20k Slayer XP is nice 😊	Med
A Taste of Hope	Want to prep for final quest in series	Low
Venator Bow	Makes Slayer and Range training free	Med
Eye of Ayak	Budget Tumeken's Shadow (so very good)	Med
74 Construction	Rejuvenation Pool + Other Stuff	High
65 Runecrafting	Hard Ardougne Diary	Med
Rainments Set	I do NOT want to get 77 RC for Elite Varrock	High
Recipe for Disaster	Barrows Gloves are TOO good for the price	High
93 Herblore	Divine Super Combats 🙄	Low
99 Woodcutting	Swag	Low

Green = Completed, Yellow = Partial, Red = Not Started

Lowkey if I didn't buy 8 weeks of membership with in-game currency I could've had an Ayak and Venator but I wanted to see if I could play f2p. While I COULD pay for membership f2p it does stall my gear upgrades a lot and it also just feels like a j*b since I have to get around 850k gp (read: gold) a day to sustain membership. This is further confirmed by some friends who said sustaining membership f2p was only done for lategame/endgame players whose grinds inherently pay for membership.

Thoughts on OSRS

As a product, OldSchool RuneScape stands at the pinnacle of a few different gaming genres/trends:

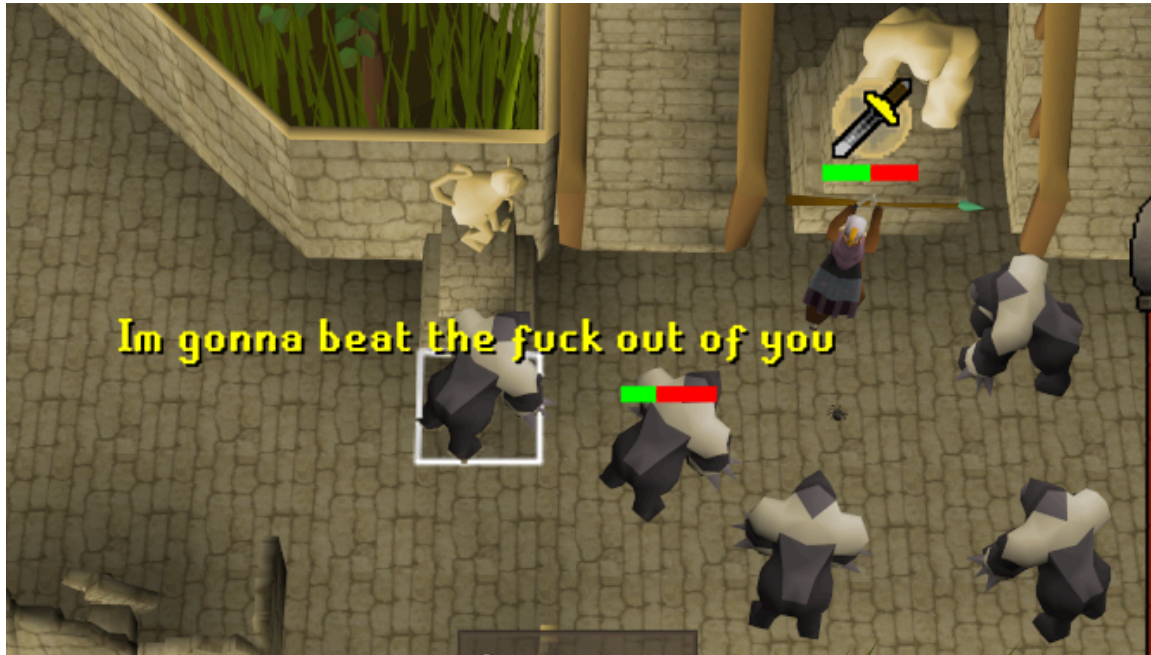
- Nostalgia Bait
 - I've been seeing this a LOT with MMOs lately and initially OSRS was just a 1-to-1 copy of a 2007 archive. Honestly with all the non-MMO remakes that have been released I think there is a trend of just reheating nachos and selling it.
- MMORPGs
 - I don't think it has the same amount of players as FFXIV or WoW but it's definitely still one of the first games people bring up when MMOs are mentioned
- Community Feedback
 - In addition to in-game polls deciding new content/items/updates the employees frequent social media and the game with many allegedly playing on their personal accounts during work
- Mobile Gaming
 - OSRS might be one of the only PC games that can have a (relatively) seamless transition to mobile due to its point-and-click gameplay. While most folks only use mobile for more relaxing content there's always one freak who surprise the community and devs alike
- Player Driven Software
 - The most popular game client isn't even owned by the OSRS team - instead it's a 3rd party program that rose in popularity due to its ability to load community plug-ins. This, by extension, allows players to create mods to implement custom rules, trackers to alleviate the difficulty in a boss fight, and cosmetic overrides to play a CS:GO crate opening animation every time a chest is opened.
- Being British
 - BO' OL O' WO' OH
- Deranged Players
 - With enough creativity, a player could essentially turn OSRS into a sandbox game with some of the most popular Youtube playthroughs relying on custom rules to construct a narrative for both passerbys and the OSRS community. Fun fact, I actually started playing OSRS because of a series I watched while playing Maplestory: [Tileman by Settled](#)
 - And for the truly deranged we have exhibit A: Limpwurt. A player so unapologetic about his personality that it's become a part of his playthrough.

As a game there were highlights from the original game state and its current (and subsequently diverged) iteration:

- Resource acquisition and requisition
 - The game economy and design is centered around two core gameplay loops: Gathering/Processing resources to Kill monsters which drop loot to either speed up the gathering/processing OR the killing after some additional processing. For example, a fisher would sell their raw goods to a chef who would cook the fish. That fish would then be used as healing supplies during fights. Once the spoils of war are collected, the cycle repeats since food shockingly disappears when consumed.
- Point-and-Click gameplay that still enables levels of skill expression
 - It might be the easiest game for AGI to learn. #justsaying
 - Jokes aside it sets up an incredible learning platform for new players to come to grips with the game. Once they learn foundational concepts various game mechanics slowly reveal themselves until the player finds themselves utilizing every trick in the book to clear certain challenges.
- Intentionally leveraging player attention as a resource for resources/experience
 - I've mentioned this previously but seeing game developers explicitly tune various activities in accordance to their APM is incredible. Not only does it disincentivize macros/automation it's also generally implemented in a social way. For example, the most popular combat training method is a 10 minute AFK-able boss that is essentially a punching bag. Since it has infinite health everyone ends up gathering in the same spot and just yapping about whatever.
- Ancient quest design and associated arbitrary skill requirements
 - While a lot of RPGs suffer from repeating the Kill X, Follow Y, Gather Z design, OSRS goes so far in the other direction that individual quests feel like an entire storyline. In conjunction with its design of quest rewards, OSRS has stories with such a unique charm that might be impossible to recreate in today's environment because it is honestly illogical.
- Powercreep constantly kept in check
 - Now of course after over 10 years of content updates there is powercreep but it's done in such a tasteful way that a player with BiS from 2016 could still reasonably jump into endgame content. This is further magnified by how skill levels never depreciate in value. A 99 in a skill will unlock ANY content in that skill. Regardless of when it was achieved a max skill will stay relevant.
- New content developed for early/midgame players
 - While most content is geared towards late/endgame players, various bosses have been introduced with the intention of teaching new players

bossing mechanics. Personally I think they're still 1-2 bosses away but honestly the jump from boss to boss really isn't a main concern in my eyes. I'm just lazy LOL.

- Minigames/Quests that almost function like a trauma bonding ritual



A very normal and unscripted Monkey Madness 1 playthrough

- Due to the nature of many rewards being locked behind quests and minigames the community ends up bonding over the good AND bad. Looking at YOU Ratcatchers. And if you want to trigger a subset of players you can always ask about their time in the red prison.
- The wilderness being a PvP zone
 - This might be the coolest *conceptual* idea in the game since it basically confines all PvP into one region. Canonically it's a lawless land but due to its lack of development there's a lot of riches to be had. From a player perspective this basically means lots of low-requirement money printers are located there with the drawback being the threat of a wandering Player Killer (PKer). There's a lot of nuance but basically anyone can attack a player for any reason to take their items so in almost every guide there's a warning outlining this risk and recommendations on how to minimize loss when you inevitably get obliterated.
- Instant dopamine doesn't exist
 - This will be one of the more divisive opinions since I personally appreciate the fact that the graphics are mostly stuck in 2007. In conjunction with the general investment needed for quests, skills, and gear, it results in a game that stands on the opposite side of modern game feedback loops. It has to rely on its innate design to entice and retain players. Specifically, my

hot take is that any game that utilizes stunning visuals or aura farming moments in their marketing end up spiraling in a vicious cycle of powerscaling visual effects.

- Oh and I guess it goes without saying that there's no microtransactions including battle passes, cosmetics, or gacha
- As a fun addendum for MMO nerds, I also hate transmogs since they devalue rare cosmetics and call into question any scuffed build. If I am running a poverty build I want everyone to know IMMEDIATELY with no questions asked.

Blog-iversary Resolutions

Now that I look back, a year is a LONG time so I'm pretty hesitant to put out any goals for such a long time frame. However I did enjoy going back and reviewing my initial goals so I'll have two categories: OSRS goals (kept brief) and Blog goals.

OSRS

- 50 Vorkath KC
- Giant Mole pet
- 99 Range and 99 Strength
- The Fractured Archive (Raids 4) rewards: Ascension Crossbows and Zorya's Tome
- Thread of Elidnis (from ToA Raids 3)
- Elite Combat Achievements
- Elite Falador Diary
- Dianza's Quiver

Blogs:

- Book Review: Neumann's Shoulder Chapter
- Book Review: Methods in Computational Stochastics
- Book Review: Applied Elasticity
- Book Review: Journey Across Japan

So with those goals listed, we'll look back in a year to see if I actually hit all of these goals.